DRAMA

11/02/26

Syllabus - D - Detailed, ND - Not Detailed

Imp - Lessons in red are studied in each unit

12/02/26

1. Unit - I

Christopher Marlowe - Dr. Faustus D

Ben Johnson - The Alchemist ND

John Webster - The Duchess of Malfi ND

2. Unit - II

William Shakespeare - Hamlet D
The Tempest ND
Henry V ND

3. Unit - III

William Congreve - The Way of the World D

Oliver Goldsmith - She Stoops to Conquer ND

Richard Brinsley Sheridan - The School for Scandal ND

4. Unit - IV

G. B Shaw - St. Joan D

T. S Eliot - Murder in the Cathedral ND

Henrik Ibsen - A Doll's House ND

5 Unit - V

Anton Chekhov - The Cherry Orchard ND

Brecht - Mother Courage and her Children ND

Edward Albee - The Zoo Story D

Unit - 1

12/8/26

Christopher Marlowe - Dr. Faustus D

Summary and context -

Tells the story of Dr. Faustus, a brilliant german scholar who is dissatisfied with traditional subjects like logic, medicine, law and theology. He turns to necromancy (black Magic) to gain unlimited knowledge and power.

He summons Mephistopheles, a servant of lucifer and makes a pact; Dr. John Faustus will give his soul to the devil in exchange for 24 years of magical power.

As the 24 years end, he feels fear and regret but cannot truly repent. In the final scene, devil drags him to hell. The play ends with a moral lesson about ambition and damnation.

About the writer - Era, Admirers, Titles -

Christopher Marlowe (1564 - 1593)

Era and Age - Elizabethan Age, 16th Century (1558-1603)

Titles -

1. "Father of English Tragedy" - literary critics
2. "Morning Star of English Drama" - Critics (because he prepared the way for shakespeare)

Admirers -

- Influenced shakespeare
- Goethe admired Doctor Faustus

Critics -

Accused of Atheism
- Criticized for violent and rebellious heroes.

Contribution -

- Perfected blank verse
- Introduced the "Overreacher" tragic hero
- Brough grandeur to English Drama

Themes - of drama "Dr. Faustus"

1. Ambition and Overreaching - Faustus represents a renaissance ambition.
2. Good Vs Evil - Represented by Good Angel

and evil angel. Inner moral conflict

Characters -

Dr. John Faustus → Scholar, intellectual
→ ambitious, arrogant, restless
→ Central tragic hero
→ Represents human ambition and overreacher

Mephistopheles / Mephistophilis → Devil, servant
→ Intelligent Ironic
→ Represents Temption and hell's suffering

Good and Evil angels → Symbolize inner conscience
→ Inner moral conflict

Important Quotes -

1. "Was this the face that launched a thousand ships?"

Spoken by Faustus about Helen of Troy meaning that he admires her beauty

Shows illusion and wasted power.

2. "A sound magician is a mighty god"

Faustus says this and it shows his pride and desire to become god-like.

3. "I'll burn my books!"

In the final scene, said by Faustus. His regret for choosing magic over religion.

4. "Why, this is hell, nor am I out of it."

Spoken by Mephistopheles. Hell is a state of mind and separation from god. Psychological hell, not just physical.

Unit-2

1 12/02/26

William Shakespeare - The Tempest NO

Summary and Context -

Prospero, the Duke of Milan, is betrayed by his brother Antonio and exiled to an Island with his daughter, Miranda. On the Island, he learns Magic and controls Spirits like Ariel and Caliban.

After 12 years, he creates a tempest (storm) to bring his enemies to the island. Through magic, he tests them. Eventually he forgives Antonio, frees Ariel and prepares Miranda marriage to Ferdinand.

This play ends with forgiveness and reconciliation.

1. Themes - of drama "Tempest"

1. Forgiveness - Prospero forgives his enemies.

2. Power and control - Prospero controls the island and its people.

3. Colonization - Caliban represents colonized Native.

Characters -

Prospero
- Wise, Magician, authoritative presence
- Intelligent, powerful, controlling, later forgiving
- Central figure who controls the action of the play
- Symbol of Art, knowledge, Authority, colonizes sometimes shakespeare himself.

Miranda
- Young, beautiful, innocent girl
- pure, compassionate, object yet emotionally strong
- Emotional center of play
- Hope, purity, new beginnings, future harmony

Ariel
- Airy spirit (Invisible, light, magical being)
- Loyal, obedient, intelligent, gentle
- Spiritual freedom

Caliban
- Wild, deformed, half human creature
- Angry, rebellious, emotional
- Native inhabitant of land
- physical slavery

Alonso → King of Naples, Royal and dignified
→ proud at first later remorseful
→ Father of Ferdinand
→ Political authority
→ Flawed rulers who can change

Antonio → Duke of Milan (usurper), serious and cunning
→ Ambitious, Manipulative, power hungry

Ferdinand → Young Handsome prince
→ Noble, Sincere
→ Marries Miranda, unites Milan and Naples
→ True love, fresh beginning

Important Quotes –

1. "We are such stuff as dreams are made on". – prospero

Life is temporary and illusion like.

2. "O brave new world, that has such people in't!" - Miranda

Shows her innocence and optimism.

3. "The rarer action is in virtue than

in vengeance." – prospero

Forgiveness is greater than revenge.

About the writer – Age, Admirers, Titles –

William Shakespeare (1564 – 1616)

Age – Elizabethan & Jacobean Age, late 16th and Early 17th century (1558 – 1625)

Titles –

1. "Bard of Avon" – Popular traditional title
2. Ben Jonson called him "Soul of the Age"
3. known as National poet of England

Admirers – Ben Jonson, Coleridge, Charles Lamb

Critics –

1. Voltaire criticised his irregular plots.
2. Dr. Johnson criticised lack of classical unity

Contribution – Master of tragedy and comedy, psycological characterization, Enriched english language, Universal Themes.

Hamlet -

Summary and Context -

Tragedy by Shakespeare set in Denmark.

The play begins when ghost of King Hamlet appears to soldiers and later to prince hamlet. The ghost reveals he was murdered by his own brother, Claudius, who has now become king and married Hamlet mother, Queen Gertrude.

13/02/26 The Ghost commands hamlet to takes revenge.

Hamlet is deeply disturbed, instead of acting immediately, he begins to question everything - life, death, morality, revenge and truth. To investigate Claudius guilt, Hamlet pretends to be mad. He stages a play ("The mousetrap") that re-enacts the murder. Claudius reacts guiltily, confirming the crime.

However, Hamlet delays killing Claudius. When he finally has the chance, Claudius is praying and he hesitates again. Soon after he mistakenly kills polonius, thinking he is Claudius hiding

behind to a curtain.

This leads to ophelia getting mad and drowning (suicide). Laertes, polonius son returns seeking revenge

In the final duel, Hamlet, Laertes, Claudius and Gertrude all dies.

Themes - of "Hamlet"

1. Revenge and delay - The moral struggle of avenging wrongs.

2. Appearance vs. Reality - Nothing is what it seems.

3. Madness - Hamlet pretends; Ophelia truly collapses.

Characters -

Hamlet
- → Young Prince, dressed in black (mourning)
- → Intelligent, philosophical, sensitive, indecisive, ironic
  - → Represents doubt and self awareness
- → Central tragic hero
- → Struggles between morality and revenge

King Claudius
- Royal, Confident, Politically smooth
- Ambitious, manipulative
- Main Antagonist

Queen Gertrude
- Graceful Queen
- Emotional, weak
- Moral weakness, Human frailty

Ophelia
- Gentle, innocent Young women
- Obedient, pure, emotionally fragile
- Female innocence destroyed by patriarchy

Polonius
- Elderly Court advisor
- Talkative, spying, manipulative but foolish
- Political interference and superficial wisdom

1. Laertes
- Young Nobleman
- passionate, impulsive, Action-oriented
- Man of Action (Contrast to Hamlet

The Ghost
- Armored Spirit of dead King
- Commanding Mysterious
- Revenge, Moral justice

Fortinbras
- Brave, decisive
- Political order and restoration
- Ends the Chaos and restores Stability

Important Quotes -

1. "To be, or not to be : that is the question."
Hamlet
Nobler to live and suffer or to end's one life.

2. "Something is rotten in the State of Denmark"
Marcellus
Political corruption and moral decay.

3. "Frailty, thy name is woman!" Hamlet
Expresses anger towards his mother for marrying Claudius.

4. "The rest is silence." Hamlet, Final Scene

Final words before dying. Symbolizes acceptance of death and end of his sufferings.

Unit-3

23/02/26

Oliver Goldsmith - She Stoops to Conquer
NO

Summary and Context -

Mr. Hardcastle wants his daughter Kate to marry Marlow. Due to misunderstanding, Marlow thinks Hardcastle's house is an inn (Pub, hotel for traveller's).

Marlow is shy with upper-class women but bold with lower-class girls. Kate "stoops" (pretends to be maid (barmaid)) to win his love.

Finally, truth is revealed and marriage is arranged.

About the writer -

Oliver Goldsmith (1728 - 1774)

1. Era and Age - Neoclassical / Age of Johnson / Augustan age
18th Century (1750 - 1798)

Titles -

1. "Poet of Rural life" - Literary Critics

2. Member of Johnson literary Club.

Admirers - Dr. Samuel Johnson, Edmund Burke

Critics - Criticized for sentimentality. Some called his style too simple

Contribution -

- Revived sentimental comedy
- Blended humor with moral lessons
- Depicted Village life beautifully

Themes of "She Stoops to Conquer" -

1 Social Class - House mistaken as inn.

2. Love and marriage - Romantic Comedy structure

Characters -

Kate → Beautiful, Intelligent
→ Symbolizes Clever Womanhood
Hardcastle → Triumph of wit, agency and intellect

Charles → Shy, but arrogant
Marlow → Represents Class Hypocrisy
"Young Marlow" → Son of Charles Marlow (Mr. Hardcastle friend)
→ Witty, Observant and easily flustered

Rough looking, Cheerful
Mischievous, witty, Practical

Anthony → Kate's maternal half-brother
"Tony" from her mother's first
dumpkin marriage, older than Kate

Important Quotes-

1. "Ask me no question, and I'll tell you no lies" Tony dumpkin

Comic mischief and misunderstanding

2. "I can read your heart in your face" Kate to Marlow

Shows her intelligence and control

1.

Unit-4

13/02/26

Henrik Ibsen - A Doll's House ND

Summary and Context -

Nora helmer, a seemingly cheerful housewife, secretely borrows money by forging her father signature to save her husband Torvald helmer.

14/02/26 Later her husband only cares for himself and his reputation after knowing about the loan, she leaves him (famous door slam).

About the writer -

Henrik Ibsen (1828 - 1906)

Era and Age - Modern Age, 19th Century (1890 - 1950)

Titles and who gave them -

1. "Father of Modern Drama" - Literary Critics

2. "Father of realism" - Literary historians

Critics -

- Criticized for attacking social institutions
- "Ghosts" drama called immoral by early

Critics

Admirers - George Bernard Shaw, James Joyce

Contribution -

- Introduced realism in drama.
- Social problem Plays
- Psychological depth
- Feminist themes

Themes of drama "doll house" -

1. Feminism - Women struggle for independence and equality.

2. Marriage and Patriarchy - Unequal power dynamics.

Characters -

1

Nora → Cheerful, lively
→ Brave, clever, resourceful, evolving
→ Modern women. Self identity
Helmer → Feminism and self-discovery

Torvald → Authoritative, proper
→ Dominating
Helmer → Patriarchy

Important Quotes -

1. "I have been your doll-wife." - Nora

She realizes her oppressed condition.

2. "I must stand quite alone." - Nora

Her decision to find identity

3. "Before all ~~est~~ else, you are a wife and a mother." - Torvald Helmer

Patriarchal thinking

Unit-5

1 - 14/02/26

Edward Albee - The Zoo Story D

Summary and Context -

Peter, a middle class man, sits in Central Park. Jerry, a lonely man, approaches him and narrates his troubled life.

Jerry tries to force Communication. Eventually he provokes Peter into stabbing him. Jerry dies, achieving Connection through violence.

About the Writer -

Edward Albee (1928 - 2016)

Era and Age - 20th Century, Modern / Postmodern American drama (1945 - Present)

1. Titles -

1. Major figure of Theatre of the Absurd - Critics Classification
2. Pulitzer prize Winner - Officially awarded

Admirers - Respected in American Theatre

Critics - Harsh realism, plays disturbing

Contribution -

1. Brought absurdism to America
2. Explored illusion vs reality
3. Deep psychological Conflicts

Themes of the Drama "Zoo Story" -

1. Isolation & Modern loneliness
2. Communication breakdown and failure of real dialogue
3. Absurdity of life and meaningless existence.

Characters -

Jerry
- Alienated, aggressive outsider
- Externalized trauma, Violent and loud
- Seeks Connection violently
- Loneliness, Childhood pain
- Existential despair

Peter
- Passive, middle-Class Comfort
- Internalized trauma, Shocked & reflective
- Emotional numbness, Comfort without Connection
- Avoidance / repression, fear of Confrontation

Important Quotes -

1. "I've been to the zoo". Jerry

Isolation and human condition

2. "Sometimes, it is necessary to go to a long distance out of the way." Jerry

Extreme action needed to communicate.

3. "Don't touch me." - Peter

Fear of emotional connection.